

IELTS LISTENING

1000 Most Used Spelling Words

SECTION 1 Words with Double Letters

Double-letter pairs are shown in **red**. These are the most common spelling traps in IELTS Listening answers.

week days	week end	stamp col lection	orien te ering
billi ar ds	ch es s	pot te ry	woo d carving
business es management	special off er	col l ecting data	questi on naire
mass es media	po ll	business es card	train ee
newsle tt er	group discus si on	pro o freading	writt en work
text bo ok	ass es sment	class ro om	att en dance
spe ee ch	main hall l	placement test	col l ege
dining ro om	acc om modation	overseas students	full-t im e
media ro om	comm en cement	diss er tation	sch oo l reunion
fee d back	resources ro om	st aff	bachelor's deg re e
registr ar 's off ice	occ u pation	prof es sion	engin ee r
prof es sor	waitr es s	volun te er	curr ic ulum vitae
fre el ance	mail add ress	off ic e ass istant	acc ou ntant
light att endant	kee ep -fit	outd oo r activities	balanced diet
fo od pyramid	piz za	seaf oo d	egg s
che es e	gre en pe pper	blackcurr an t	egg yolk
fo ot bridge	villag e	waterfal l	ree f
val l ey	typh oo n	hill l	cliff ff
flood dd	hur rr icane	foss il fuels	gre en house eff ect
burning foss il	poll u tion	landfil ll	catt le
environmental l y friendly	chemical-free e	ocean curr re nts	firewo od
Gree ce	the Phil ipp ines	Russ ian	Gree k
glass ss house	bed ro om	thatched cott tt age	terr rr aced house
neighbour ho od	coff ee table	ground flo or	hall ll way
stre et	embass ss y	ferr ry	nar rr owboat
padd le steamer	hot-air ballo on	pass en ger	st aff selection
app oi ntment	col l eague	technical co operation	show ro om
stress ss	employ ee	local library	swimm ing pool
cott tt age	book ss hop	cante en	ann ua l fee
tuition fee s	curr re nt acc ount	student acc ount	interest-free credit
ann ui ty	duty-free store	po or quality	disapp oi nted

efficient	strongly recommended	spotted	ticket office
tourist attraction	necessary	dull	affordable
immense	pessimistic	collect	surpass
support	discuss	suggest	arrange
borrow	immigrate	jet-skiing	baseball
basketball	hang-gliding	soccer	american football
swimming	tennis	bungee jumping	jogging
press-up	snooker	barbell	treadmill
mass	breeze	chilly	cool
freezing	antenna	cassette	screen
classical music	art gallery	ballet	mammals
mushroom	roots	seed	forklift truck
school bus	lorry	jeep	freight train
goods train	midday	millennium	fulltime
part-time	copper	steel	rubber
cotton	wool	glass	wood
fiberglass	green	yellow	sufficient
guarantee	commerce	narrative	satellite
attitude	traffic jams	opportunity	process
umbrella	life expectancy	farewell	illiteracy

SECTION 2 Vocabulary by Topic Group

All words organised by topic category.

Days of the Week

Monday	Tuesday	Wednesday	Thursday
Friday	Saturday	Sunday	weekdays
weekend			

Months of the Year

January	February	March	April
May	June	July	August
September	October	November	December

Hobbies

gardening	stamp collection	orienteering	caving
spelunking	scuba-diving	snorkeling	skateboarding
bowls	archery	ice skating	darts
golf	billiards	photography	painting
embroidery	climbing	chess	parachute
pottery	woodcarving		

Subjects

science	politics	architecture	law
geography	history	biology	archaeology
literature	statistics	mathematics	performing arts
visual arts	logic	physics	psychology
anthropology	economics	philosophy	chemistry
humanities	business management	agriculture	

Marketing

catalogue	interview	research method	entertainment industry
TV program	strategies	leadership	management
customer	special offer	collecting data	display
products	questionnaire	survey	mass media
poll	business card	training	trainee
statistic	profit margin	newsletter	competition
merchandise	manufacture	recruitment	

Studying at College / University

course outline	group discussion	handout	research
proofreading	experiment	written work	report writing
experience	reference	textbook	student advisor
teamwork	module	topic	dictionary
laptop	printer	assessment	library
department	computer centre	classroom	attendance
deadline	give a talk	speech	lecture
tutor	main hall	computer laboratory	certificate
diploma	placement test	facilities	college
dining room	specialist	knowledge	international
accommodation	overseas students	full-time	home stay
primary	secondary	intermediate	media room
commencement	dissertation	leaflet	school reunion
feedback	tasks	outcomes	advanced
introductory	extra background	resources room	staff
higher education	guidelines	post-secondary	faculty
pupils	pencil	supervisor	bachelor's degree
compound	foreign students	schedule	vocabulary
student support services	student retention	publication	registrar's office
stationery			

Works and Jobs

designer	occupation	profession	decorator
architect	engineer	waiter	teacher
vacancy	professor	specialist	manager
waitress	psychologist	volunteer	craftsman

work experience	curriculum vitae	freelance	secretary
mail address	receptionist	pilot	lecturer
office assistant	clerk	accountant	guard
light attendant	cashier	captain	

Health & Food

yoga	tai-chi	keep-fit	salad bar
vegetarian	outdoor activities	leisure time	disease
meal	protein	balanced diet	food pyramid
vitamin	carbohydrates	rice	pasta
potatoes	pizza	tomatoes	bread
cereals	minerals	zinc	meat
seafood	eggs	beans	milk
cheese	yoghurt	fruit	vegetables
citrus fruits	green pepper	blackcurrant	nuts
egg yolk	liver	medicine	treatment
remedy	nursing care	nursery	regular exercise

Nature

field	footbridge	river	mountain
forest	village	environment	waterfall
coast	reef	lake	valley
peninsula	earthquake	avalanche	tornado
typhoon	hill	cliff	island
desertification	volcano	disaster	landslides
storm	flood	hurricane	pond
catastrophe	erosion	jungle	oasis
dam	canyon		

The Environment

coal	fossil fuels	acid rain	global warming
carbon dioxide	greenhouse effect	burning fossil	exhaust fumes
smog	climate	pollution	temperature
power plants	deforestation	nitrogen oxide	landfill
cattle	wind turbine	renewable	source of energy
reliable	solar panels	solar power	hydroelectric power
environmentally friendly	oxygen	chemical-free	vegetation
sea level	ocean currents	soil conditioner	firewood
desert	degradation	drought	contaminated

Continents

Australia	Africa	South America	North America
Asia	Europe	Antarctica	

Countries

Switzerland	Turkey	England	Egypt
Mexico	Germany	Greece	Brazil
India	North Korea	France	Indonesia
Malaysia	New Zealand	United Kingdom	China
Italy	Nigeria	Pakistan	Singapore
the Philippines	Denmark		

Languages

Japanese	German	linguistics	bilingual
trilingual	polyglot	Portuguese	Mandarin
Bengali	Chinese	Hindi	Russian
Punjabi	Thai	Persian	Filipino
French	Italian	Greek	

Architecture & Buildings

dome	palace	fort	castle
glasshouse	pyramid	log cabin	lighthouse
hut	skyscraper	sculpture	

Homes

chimney	bedroom	semi-detached house	duplex
town house	row house	bungalow	thatched cottage
mobile home	houseboat	block of flats	apartment building
condominium	basement	landlord	terraced house
tenant	rent	lease	neighbourhood
suburb	dormitory	storey	kitchen
refrigerator	microwave	sofa	coffee table
ground floor	oven	hallway	insurance

In the City

central station	cities	street	lane
city centre	car park	department store	bridge
temple	hospital	garden	avenue
embassy	road system		

Transportation

boat	lifeboat	cargo plane	shipment
container ship	ferry	liner	canal boat
narrowboat	dinghy sailing	hovercraft	hydrofoil
sailboat	paddle steamer	cabin cruiser	kayak
canoe	punt	gondola	aircraft

rowing boat	rowboat	helicopter	seaplane
airship	hot-air balloon	airport	platform
hire a car	automobile	crew	passenger

Workplaces

staff selection	clinic	dentist	reception
appointment	colleague	workshop	employer
employment	unemployed	technical cooperation	team leaders
showroom	information desk	stress	ability
vision	employee	internship	confidence

Places

parliament	accommodation	local library	swimming pool
cafeteria	cottage	restaurant	bookshop
sports centre	city council	canteen	cafe
dance studio	park	conversation club	kindergarten

Money Matters

cash	debit	low-risk investment	credit card
cheque	annual fee	monthly membership	tuition fees
poverty	bank statement	money management	current account
interest rate	deposit	student account	withdraw
mortgage	grace period	in advance	budget deficit
retail voucher	coupon	counterfeit money	debt
interest-free credit	purchase	partial refund	annuity
public money	taxpayers	money	income
non-refundable	MasterCard	VISA	duty-free store
distribution costs	finance department	family finances	

Rating & Qualities

expensive	cheap	reasonable	satisfactory
dangerous	poor quality	satisfied	disappointed
efficient	luxurious	safe	strongly recommended
colored	spotted	striped	

Touring

souvenir	trip	tourist	guided tour
ticket office	guest	reservation	view
culture	single	double bedded room	picnic
tourist attraction	hostel	suite	memorable
aquarium			

Adjectives

energetic	social	ancient	necessary
fantastic	exciting	fabulous	dull
comfortable	convenient	suitable	affordable
voluntary	mandatory	compulsory	temporary
permanent	immense	vast	salty
extinct	vulnerable	pessimistic	optimistic
realistic	practical	knowledgeable	flexible
confident	western	intensive	tranquil
spectacular	intact	various	

Verbs

train	develop	collect	supervise
mark	edit	revise	exhibit
donate	surpass	register	support
hunt	persuade	concentrate	discuss
suggest	arrange	borrow	immigrate
review	learn	touch	

Sports

jet-skiing	bodyboarding	snowboarding	cricket
baseball	basketball	rugby	hang-gliding
skydiving	soccer	american football	hockey
swimming	tennis	squash	badminton
ping-pong	court	pitch	stadium
team	horse racing	show jumping	polo
cycling	canoeing	refreshment	gymnasium
extreme sports	paragliding	abseiling	athlete
gym	bungee jumping	surfing	windsurfing
kitesurfing	mountain biking	push-up	judo
recreation	jogging	press-up	snooker
walking	barbell	treadmill	championship

Shapes & Measurements

oval	square	rectangular	triangular
polygon	spherical	circular	curved
cylindrical	length	altitude	imperial system
metric system	spiral	mass	depth
breadth	height	frequency	

Weather

humid	hot	sticky	breeze
chilly	cold	cool	dry

dusty	freezing	warm	wet
weather forecast	antenna	moisture	

Equipment & Tools

helmet	musical instrument	cassette	silicon chip
digital monitor	gadget	device	screen
mechanical pencil	disk	backpack	

Arts & Media

opera	orchestra	concert	symphony
conductor	vocalist	audience	festival
carnival	exhibition	classical music	theatre
cinemas	art gallery	museum	ballet
television	radio	graphics	newspaper

The Animal Kingdom

lion	penguin	seabirds	mammals
genus	species	cetacean	whale
primates	rodents	reptile	insects
octopus	fish	amphibian	livestock
creature			

Plants

mushroom	fungus	stem	roots
cluster	fertilizer	leaves	seed
core	bark	trunk	twig
branch	flower		

Vehicles

camper	double-decker bus	single-decker	minibus
forklift truck	school bus	coach	truck
tanker	van	lorry	transporter
tow truck	breakdown truck	pickup	jeep
taxi	cab	tram	underground
subway	caravan	tractor	steam train
freight train	goods train		

Expressions & Time

midday	millennium	a gap year	fulltime
part-time	midnight	century	decade
fortnight			

Materials

aluminum	copper	metal	steel
rubber	plastic	ceramics	cement
stone	textile	cotton	fabric
wool	glass	leather	bone
paper	lumber	glue	concrete
wax	wood	silver	fiberglass
gold	feather		

Colours

blue	white	orange	green
grey	black	red	yellow
purple	brown	pink	

Other

sufficient	dialogue	variety	private sector
practice	gender	creativity	government
individual	indigenous	demonstration	circuit
guarantee	commerce	narrative	strike
entrance	chocolate	satellite	decision
prototype	attitude	activity	recipient
ultrasound	daily routine	traffic jams	procedures
creation	opportunity	driving license	prize
process	literary	man-made	waiting list
umbrella	lunar calendar	burger	videos
fund-raising event	magnet	dialect	nature conservation
life expectancy	farewell	welfare	encyclopedia
illiteracy	robot	proficiency	evolution
revolution			